



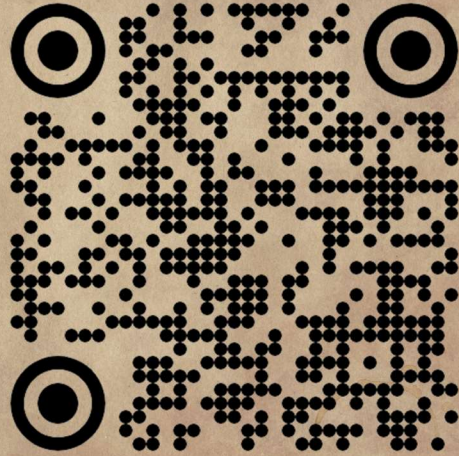
The Civil War Part 2

By Robert James

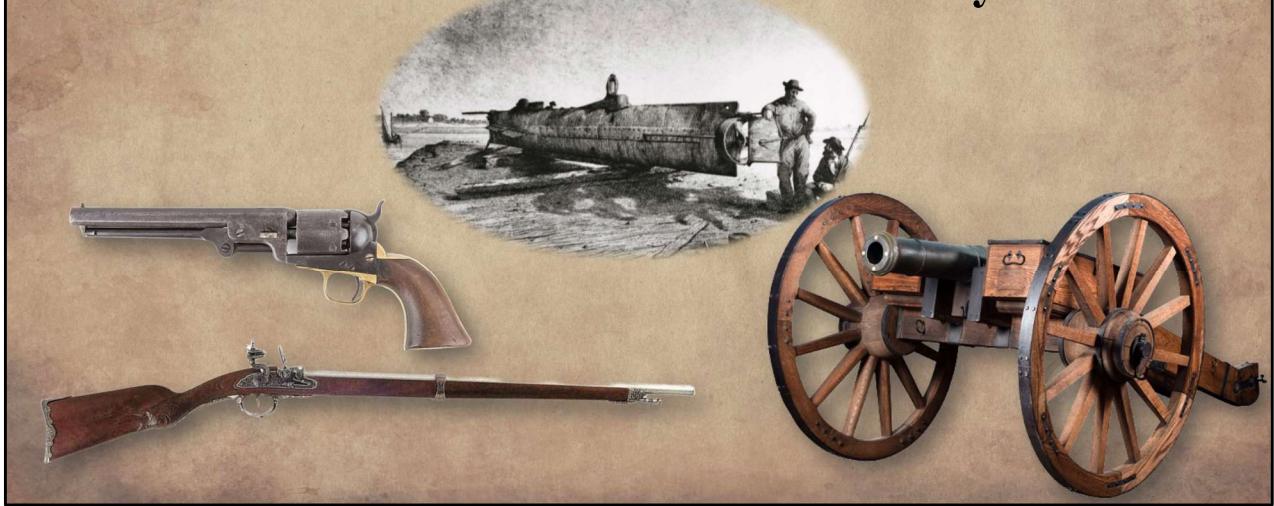


Presentation Materials

- **Scan this QR code to view the slide deck of this presentation and follow along!**
- **You can also find the recording of the previous presentation and accompanying materials!**



Last Presentation:
Battles, Weapons, Projectiles
and the Submarine CSS Hunley



In my first presentation we focused on battles, weapons, projectiles and the submarine CSS Hunley in order to give you a feel for what the officers and soldiers who fought in that war were faced with in battles on an almost daily basis that decided who lived and who died.

Who is this man?

Why is he in a Civil War Presentation?



Who is this and why is his photo in a Civil War Presentation??

“Old Blood and Guts”

- **War reduces mankind to the very lowest of human natures, for it decides who lives and who dies, in essence it forces all of its participants to live by the battlefield code of kill or be killed.**



Lt. General George S. Patton

As Lt. General George S. Patton, one of my favorite WWII generals, who was also known as “Old Blood and Guts” put it, war reduces mankind to the very lowest of human natures, for it decides who lives and who dies, in essence it forces all of its participants to live by the battlefield code of kill or be killed.

“Old Blood and Guts”

- **In his own words, “The Object of War is not to die for your country, but to make the other bastard die for his.”**
- **In battle, nothing else really matters, for war is not just about who is RIGHT, it is also more about who is LEFT in the aftermath to rebuild and recover from the massive damage inflicted by the military of both sides on the civilian populations.**



Lt. General George S. Patton

In his own words, “The Object of War is not to die for you country, but to make the other bastard die for his.” In battle, nothing else really matters, for war is not just about who is RIGHT, it is also more about who is LEFT in the aftermath to rebuild and recover from the massive damage inflicted by the military of both sides on the civilian populations.

The Civilian Impact

The Civil War and Civilian Impact

- Civilian populations faced economic chaos, starvation, and the loss of homes and family members.
- This was starkly seen during the siege of Vicksburg where residents ate rats and lived in caves.
- This presentation explores these varied impacts on civilians from both sides.



Siege of Vicksburg, May 18 – July 4, 1863

But the Civil War did take its toll on the civilian populations, a lot of whom were unwilling and terrified participants, to not only live under the code of the battlefield, but it also forced these populations, mostly in the south, to face economic chaos, starvation, loss of homes and lands and the loss of generations of family, friends and business associates. This was particularly true during the Union siege of Vicksburg, where starving residents were forced to live in caves dug out of the river banks and to eat rats to survive. So, in this presentation, I thought it only fitting to explore the varied impacts of the Civil War on the civilian populace on both sides.

Funding the Fight: North vs. South

- **War costs must be covered by operating revenue or taxes.**
- **The conflict highlighted a massive economic inequity between the manufacturing North and the agrarian South.**

Any war is expensive to fight and the costs have to be paid out of the operating revenue of each country, or by increased taxes on the population. In the case of the Civil War, the manufacturing north and the agrarian south, both part of the self same nation and economically about as different as two entities could possibly be, inequity ruled the day.

The South's "Cotton for Cash"



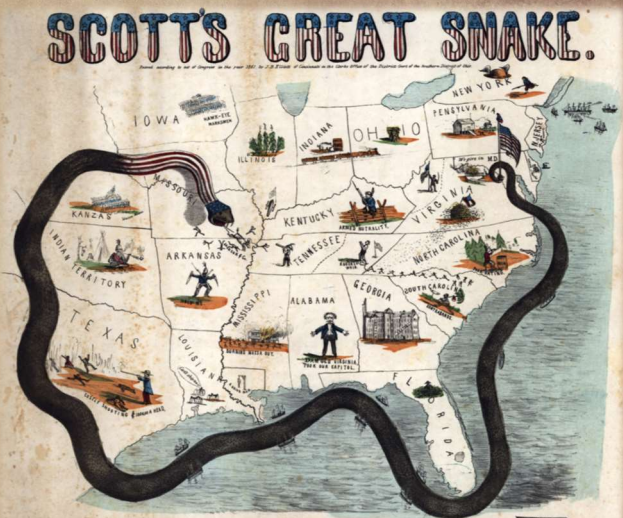
Cotton Farm, Civil War Era.

- Lacking manufacturing, the South relied on selling cotton to English textile mills.
- England considered recognizing the Confederacy, but required proof that the South could militarily defend its secession first.

The South had to rely on the sale of agricultural goods, primarily cotton, for the textile mills of England, as it had very little manufacturing base. To facilitate the "cotton for cash" proposal, England was prepared to recognize the Southern States which, via the articles of southern succession that each state had signed, became the Confederate States of America. However, England would not formally agree to this proposal until the Confederate states had proven that their succession could be militarily defended.

The Union Blockade

- After early Southern military successes, the Union realized they had to block cotton sales to win.
- The Union blockaded seacoast ports and seized control of the Mississippi River, causing England to back away from recognizing the Confederacy.

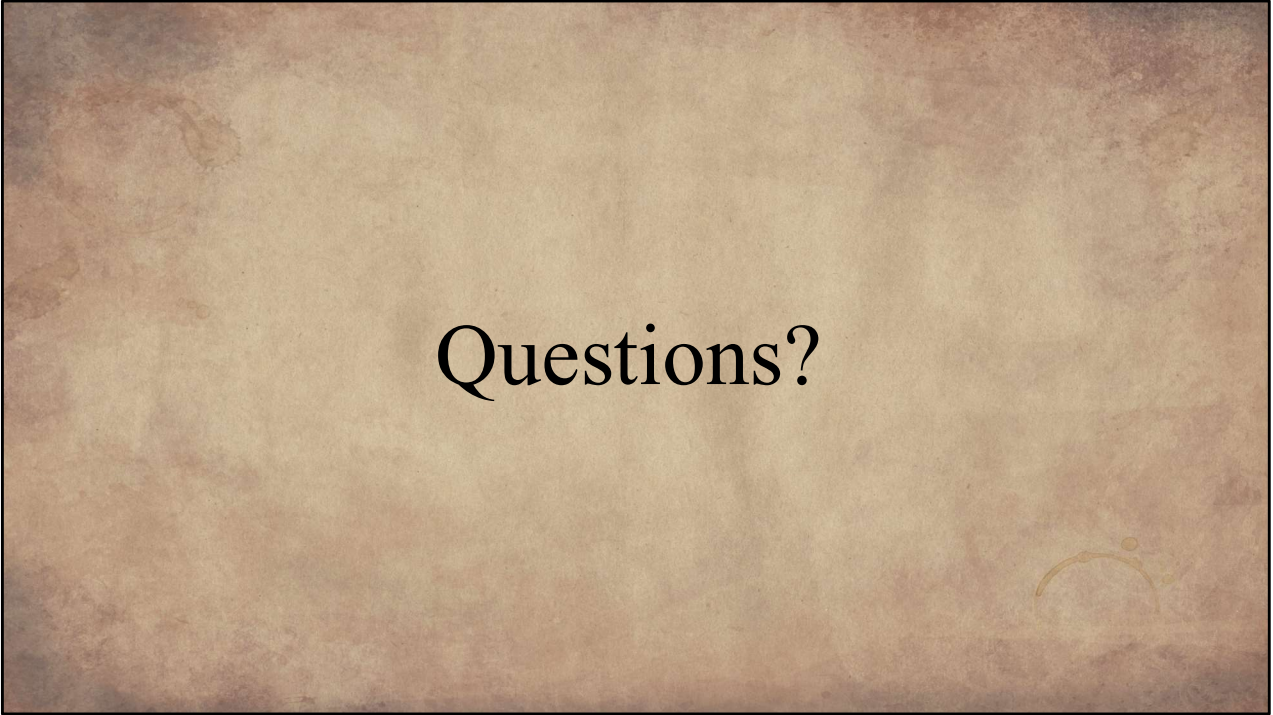


For the first two years of the war, the South was winning military battles and it appeared that they just might succeed. The Union States soon realized that to win the war, the south's sale of cotton to England had to be prevented, and thus was born the Union blockade of all seacoast ports in the south, which coupled with the loss of the major southern port city of New Orleans in 1862 and the loss of navigational control of the Mississippi River that followed the Confederate defeat at Vicksburg, it soon appeared that England was not going to formally recognize the Confederate States of America as a separate nation.

The Final Blow to King Cotton

- **Union successes against blockade runners and the major Confederate defeat at Gettysburg in 1863 killed the South's "King Cotton" funding strategy.**
- **This resulted in disaster and severe commodity shortages for Southern civilians.**

The Union had meanwhile been having notable successes in seizing and/or sinking many of the southern blockade runners, which further dampened English enthusiasm for recognizing the Confederate States of America. The final blow to the pact came with the South's major loss at the battle of Gettysburg in July of 1863, which before the loss had been considered the high point of the southern rebellion. At that point the South's plans for funding the cost of the war with the sale of agricultural products, primarily "King Cotton", to England was dead. All of these events spelled disaster for the civilian population in the south, producing major shortages in most commodities needed to ensure basic survival.



Questions?



William Tecumseh Sherman
Union General

Sherman's "Collateral Damage" Strategy

- In 1864, Union General William Tecumseh Sherman proposed inflicting collateral damage on civilians to shorten the war.
- Union leadership determined that the South's fundamental ability to wage war had to be completely eradicated.

Union General William Tecumseh Sherman's "march to the sea" in 1864 drastically compounded the misery of the southern civilian population. His idea was to inflict "collateral damage" on the civilian population as a way to shorten the war. Sherman had proposed this to General Ulysses S. Grant and President Lincoln. The Union's new military leaders, as well as the Lincoln Administration, had determined that to hasten the war's end, the Confederates must be beaten not only on the battlefield, but that the South's very ability to wage war must be eradicated.

The Hard Hand of War

- Sherman's forces targeted infrastructure by tearing up railroads and eliminating food stores.
- The goal was to make civilians feel the privations of war so deeply that they would demand peace from Richmond.
- “We are not only fighting hostile armies, but a hostile people, and must make old and young, rich and poor, feel the hard hand of war,” Sherman wrote to General Henry W. Halleck in Washington.



Wrecking the Railroads in Atlanta

Railroad tracks must be torn up, and the steel rails bent into “Sherman’s neckties”. Food stores must be eliminated, lest they feed rebel troops. Civilians, not just soldiers, must be made to feel the full extent of war’s privations, the louder to make their appeals for peace to the Confederate Government in Richmond. “We are not only fighting hostile armies, but a hostile people, and must make old and young, rich and poor, feel the hard hand of war”, Sherman wrote to General Henry W. Halleck in Washington.

The March to Atlanta

- While the North viewed this as a just way to force surrender, the South saw it as cruelty and bullying.
- The strategy centered on destroying Atlanta, a major Confederate supply and industrial hub, to deny its resources to the enemy.



To the North, this policy was a harsh but just way to push for a Southern surrender. But to the Southern population, Sherman's march was nothing more than the one-sided act of a bully, a pointless exercise in military cruelty and bravado. The plan was approved on the theory that nothing would do more to demoralize the Confederacy than to find an entire Federal Army cutting a swath thru the Southern heartland, and Sherman realized that first his troops would out of necessity destroy everything in Atlanta, the city that was the supply hub of the Confederacy and a major center of southern industry, to deny anything in the ruins that might be of use to the Confederates when they reoccupied the city after his departure.

The Destruction of Atlanta

- Troops cut telegraph lines, demolished buildings with a custom battering-ram, and twisted iron rails into "Sherman's Neckties".



- Sherman strictly ordered that only business and industrial areas be burned, forbidding the torching of dwellings.

As part of this operation, Sherman's troops cut telegraph lines, tore up railroads, using the railroad ties to heat the iron rails and then twisting the iron rails into "Sherman's Neckties", rendering them useless. His Chief Engineer had been already been busy demolishing railroad stations, warehouses and factories with a battering-ram of his own design – a 21- foot iron bar hanging by a chain from a 10- foot high sawhorse that had rammed down the stone and brick buildings until they were reduced to nothing but piles of rubble. On the evening of November 15th, Atlanta's industrial area was put to the torch. Sherman had ordered that only Atlanta's business and industrial areas be destroyed. No dwellings would be torched and no fires started at all until he reached the city to supervise.

Fire and Looting

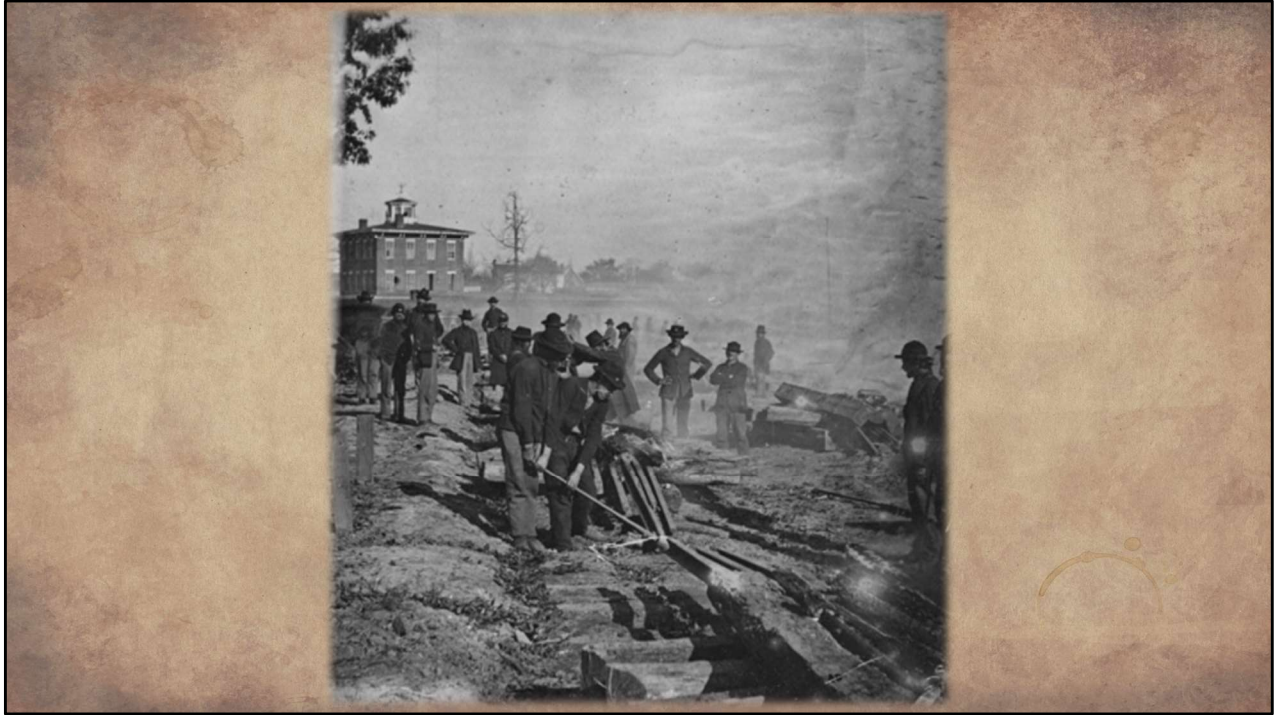
- Despite orders, civilian looters and some soldiers ransacked and burned homes, causing fires to spread into residential neighborhoods.



Arsonists would be shot on sight. But in fact, civilian looters had been ransacking and then burning empty houses since November 11th. Now more dwellings went up in flames as sporadic looting continued and the flames spread from the industrial area into some residential neighborhoods. Reports surfaced of soldiers seen battering down the doors of houses with rifle butts; stealing tobacco, whiskey, and other goods; then setting fire to the structures. Such lawlessness might have been worse had not Sherman and some of his officers spent much of the night patrolling the streets, scaring off groups of would-be looters.

Sherman Neckties





Wrecking the railroads

Ephriam Ponder House

Exterior view of the heavily-damaged Ponder House, a large section of the building on the upper floor above the porch, having collapsed, after it was struck during shelling in the battle of Atlanta, 1864. Owned by slave trader Ephriam G. Ponder, the property is often referred to as the 'Potter House.'



Exterior view of the heavily-damaged Ponder House, a large section of the building on the upper floor above the porch, having collapsed, after it was struck during shelling in the battle of Atlanta, 1864. Owned by slave trader Ephriam G. Ponder, the property is often referred to as the 'Potter House.'



Ruins of Roman Catholic Cathedral, interior view.
Charleston, South Carolina.



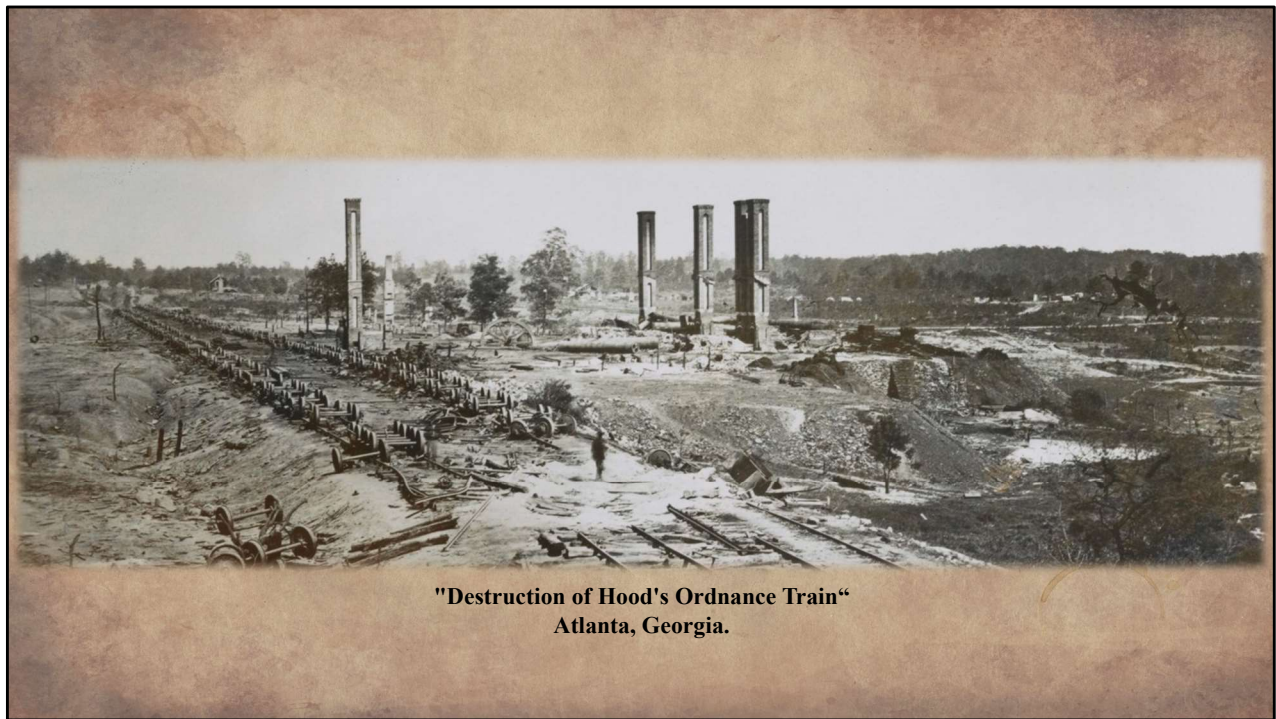
Children sit on a column of the Circular Church in
Charleston, South Carolina.

Ruins of Roman Catholic Cathedral, interior view. Charleston, South Carolina. Children sit on a column of the Circular Church in Charleston, South Carolina.



RUINS OF THE R.R. DEPOT CHARLESTON S.C.

Ruins of the Railroad Depot Charleston S.C.



The image documents the aftermath of the destruction of a Confederate military train carrying gunpowder and ordnance. The scene depicts the damage to the Georgia Central Railroad rail facilities in Atlanta, Georgia.

Spreading the Destruction

- Sherman's army repeated this destruction across cities like Savannah, Columbia, and Charleston.
- Charleston faced near-total destruction as it was viewed as the birthplace of the rebellion.



Sherman's March to the Sea, 1868 by L. Stebbins

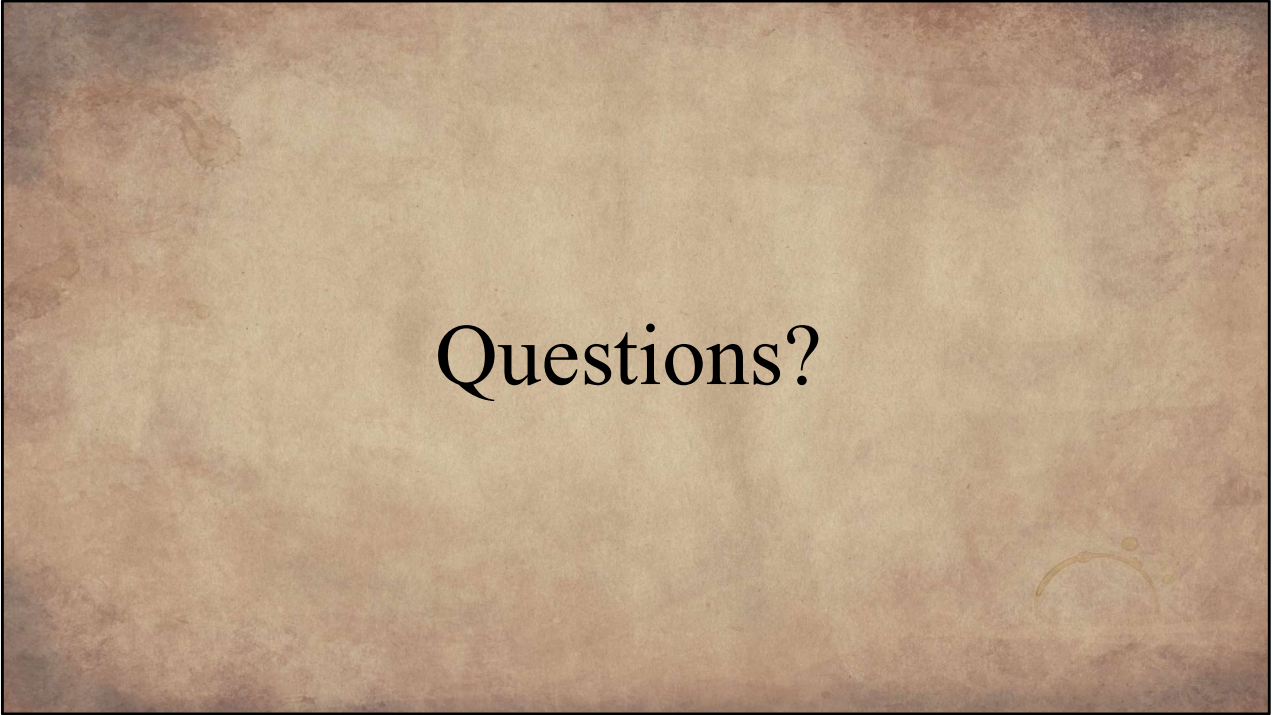
These same scenes were repeated for the duration of “Sherman’s March To The Sea”. In addition to Atlanta, which had been a key industrial hub in addition to being a major military supply depot with railroads coming into it from every direction in the south, cities like Savannah and Columbia in Georgia, and Charleston in South Carolina, where Sherman’s army wreaked near total destruction on the city that they deemed to be the hot bed of southern succession where the war really saw its start with the attack on and the seizure of Ft. Sumter in the Charleston harbor.

The Impact of Foraging



- Union troops heavily foraged for livestock, produce, and grain, plundering the South's meager resources and making civilian survival incredibly difficult.

14. Sherman's troops not only destroyed much needed military supplies, but the foraging of food (beef cattle, hogs, chickens and other livestock, preserved goods, fresh produce) as well as hay and grain for the horses (used to pull wagons, cannon and mounts for Union cavalry troops) by Sherman's army thoroughly demoralized the civilian population and made survival incredibly more difficult. This plundering of the meager resources of the south by Sherman's troops made his name hated in the south, a hatred that still exists to some degree even today.



Questions?

Impact of Foraging



We are now going to take a step back in time for you ladies in attendance. Imagine if you will that it is the fall of 1864 in the state of Georgia, or South Carolina. Your husband, and maybe even one of your older sons, are off fighting for the Confederacy. You have been left to run your small plantation, or even just a small farm, alone, or perhaps with the help of two or three younger children and maybe a helpful negro laborer. You may also have an aging parent or two that the land you own must also support.

Setting the Scene: Fall 1864

- Through careful, daily management of your land, you have managed to survive the hardships of war. Your family's survival relies entirely on your vegetable garden, carefully preserved fruits, and a small collection of livestock, including chickens, goats, and a milk cow.



You have a beautiful vegetable garden, and perhaps a fruit tree or two. What the garden and fruit trees produce are either staples on your daily table or are carefully preserved. You raise a few chickens, goats, and perhaps a sheep or two, maybe even a milk cow and calf. Life is a struggle with your husband and son off fighting the war, but you have survived thus far with careful management of what your land produces.

The Arrival of the Foragers



- On a pleasant fall day, everything suddenly changes when a Union Army foraging party arrives. Acting on the direct orders of General William Tecumseh Sherman, the soldiers systematically seize your animals, fresh produce, and preserved winter foods. Even the hay and grain meant for your animals are taken to feed the Union cavalry and wagon teams.

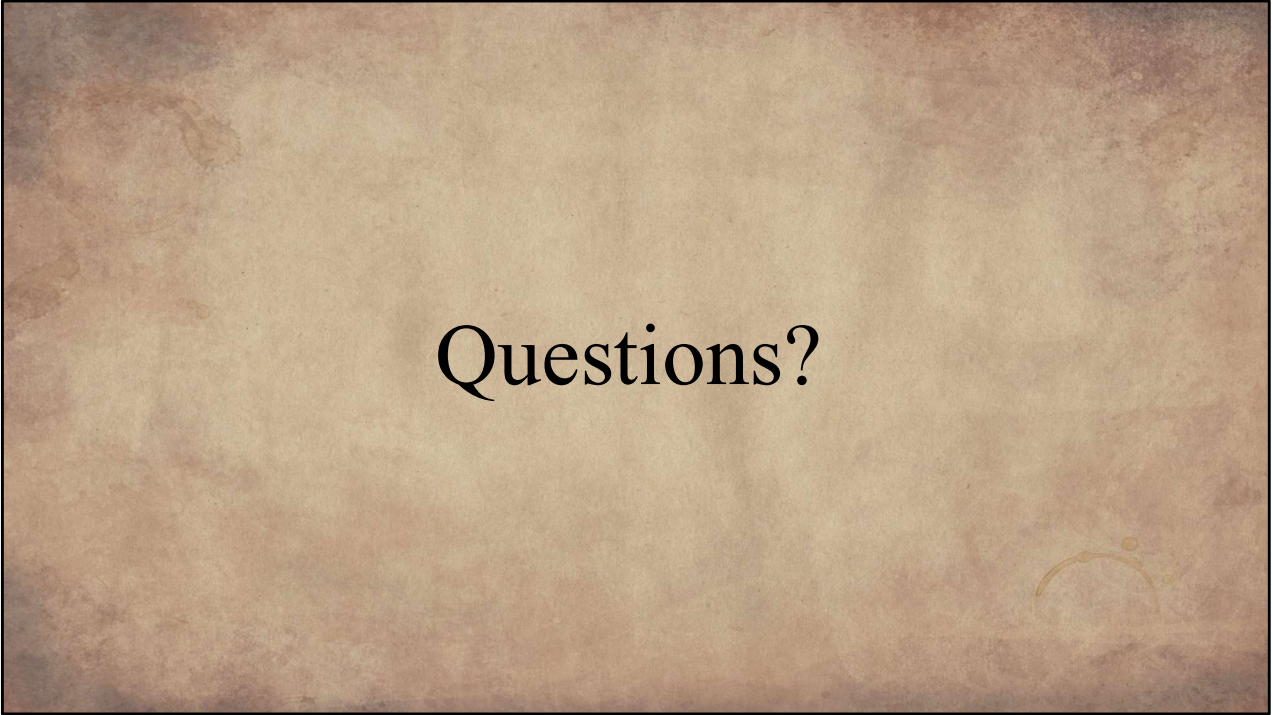
Then suddenly, everything changes. On a pleasant late fall day, a Union Army foraging party appears and begins seizing your animals, your garden produce and even your carefully preserved fruits and vegetables, to feed the approaching Union Army. They also seize any hay and grain you may have to feed the horses of the Union Cavalry and the Army wagon teams. In a matter of two or three hours your home and land are stripped of all foodstuffs and forage that were to support you through the coming winter months. You are told that this is being done on the orders of Union General William Tecumsah Sherman.

How do you keep going?

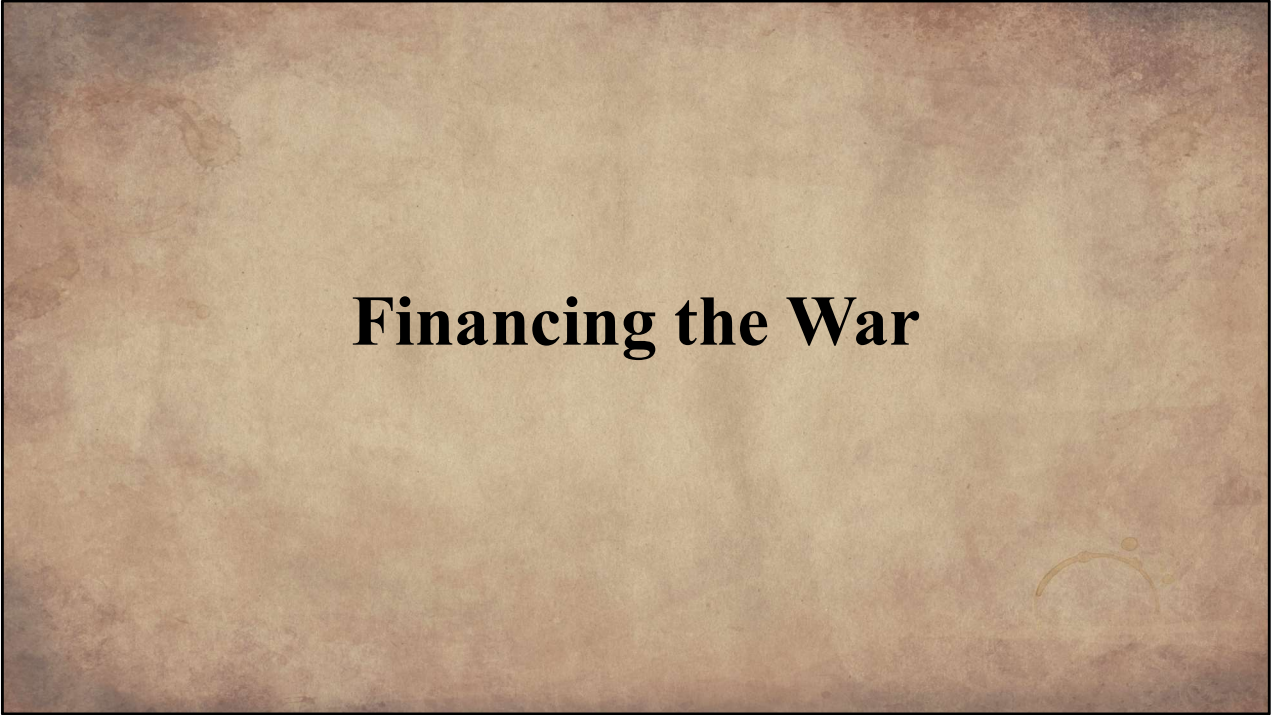
In just a few short hours, your home and land are completely stripped of all the foodstuffs and forage you required to support your family through the coming winter. Faced with this devastating loss, what are your thoughts about the war, and how will you and your family survive?

Please take a couple of minutes to reflect and share your thoughts.

What are your thoughts about the war, what has just been taken from you and how you and your family will now survive? Take a couple of minutes to think about it and if you like, briefly share your thoughts.



Questions?



Financing the War

Northern Financial Struggles

- **The Union had manufacturing capabilities but lacked the cash to pay troops and factories.**
- **Fearing hard times, Northern civilians hoarded gold, silver, and copper coins.**

The Union, on the other hand, certainly had the manufacturing base to sustain the war, but lacked the necessary cash to pay troops, to pay factories for production of war materiel (small arms, cannon, ships, uniforms and gear, and food stuffs to support troops in battle). The northern civilian population, sensing by early 1858 that hard times were coming, began hoarding hard currency (gold and silver coinage as well as even copper and copper-nickel cents to the point that any form of hard currency became extremely scarce.



Northern Financial Struggles

- **The hoarding of Government issued coins, prompted merchants to issue "store" and "patriotic" tokens.**

To compensate, northern merchants began to issue “store tokens” and “patriotic tokens” to replace the now hoarded government issued small cents.



Fractional Currency

- The Federal Government issued unpopular paper "fractional currency" to replace missing coins.



The Federal Government began to issue what was called “fractional currency” (paper money in various denominations up to \$1.00) to help compensate for the loss of hard currency from circulation. While these fractional notes (small in both size and denomination) helped, they were by no means very popular.

Encased Postage Stamps

- Some businesses used encased postage stamps.

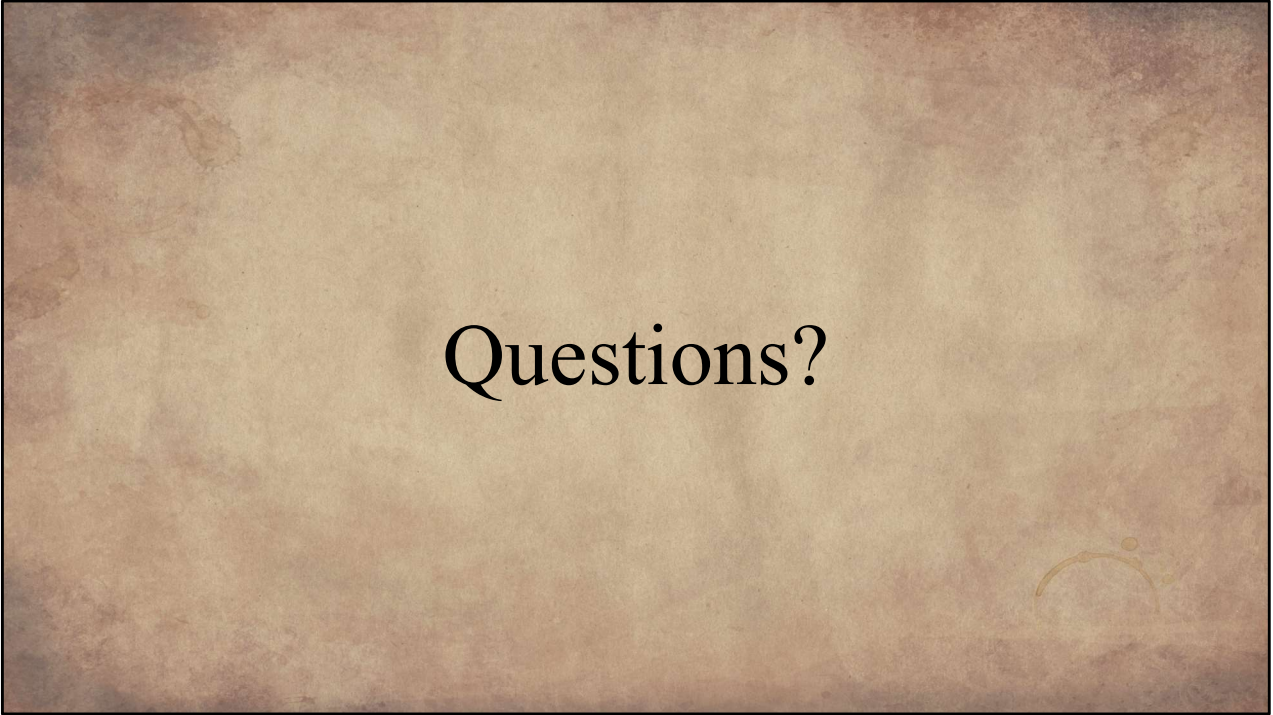


Some enterprising businesses devised a way to encase unused postage stamps in brass and mylar cases to use as currency, which were only slightly more popular than the government issued “fractional currency”.

Newly Designed Coins



While these efforts helped to somewhat alleviate currency needs for the civilian population, it did nothing to ease the government's need for cash to support the war effort. In fact, by early 1864, the government had deemed the private issuance of both patriotic and store tokens to be illegal and had the Philadelphia Mint working almost around the clock to produce all denominations of hard currency. In addition, new coins in the amounts of one, two, three, and five cents were designed, coined and put into circulation between 1862 and 1867. One of these new coins carried a motto that had never been used on government issued coins before. Can you identify which one it is??



Questions?

Pre-War Mint Expansion

- **Prior to 1835, all United States coinage was produced exclusively at the Philadelphia Mint.**
- **On March 3, 1835, Congress authorized three new branch mints: New Orleans, LA; Charlotte, NC; and Dahlonega, GA.**
- **The Charlotte and Dahlonega branches were specifically built to process newly discovered local gold, eliminating the risk and delay of transporting it to Philadelphia.**
- **By the onset of the Civil War, the New Orleans mint had become the nation's second-largest producer of high-denomination gold and silver coins.**

17. Up until 1835, all coinage for the United States was produced at one mint, in Philadelphia PA. By act of Congress on March 3rd, 1835, three branch mints were authorized: in New Orleans, LA; Charlotte NC; and Dahlonega, GA; the latter two authorized expressly for the purpose of allowing gold recently discovered near both cities to be coined near the location of the gold strikes without the need and the risk of transporting it to Philadelphia. By the beginning of the Civil War, the Branch Mint at New Orleans was second only to the Philadelphia Mint in the production of high denomination gold and silver coins.

Seizure of the Mints

- **Seceding states seized the Federal Branch Mints located within their territories.**
- **The seized assets, including valuable supplies of bullion, were turned over to the new Confederate National Government.**
- **A March 1861 estimate revealed the mints would cost far more to operate than the income they would produce.**

As states which later seceded from the Union to form the Confederacy, the state authorities seized the Federal Branch Mints in their territories. When these states joined the Confederacy, the assets of the seized mints, including their supplies of bullion, were turned over to the Confederate National Government. A March 9th, 1861 resolution passed by the Confederate Congress directed the new Confederate Secretary of the Treasury to estimate the amount of funds required to continue production at the seized mints.

Closure of the Confederate Mints

- **The Confederate Congress suspended operations to ensure public services remained self-sustaining.**
- **The New Orleans Mint's copper supply was eventually handed over to Louisiana to manufacture percussion caps for militia guns.**

When this estimate revealed that the cost of continuing the mints' operations would greatly exceed their anticipated income, the decision was made by the Confederate Congress to immediately suspend operations at the mints since it was the policy of the Confederate Government to make all branches of the public service self- sustaining. The Treasury Secretary subsequently authorized the transfer of the New Orleans Mint's supply of copper to the State of Louisiana to make percussion caps for the guns of the state Militia!

The Confederate Currency Crisis

- **By 1862, having exhausted their minted bullion, the Confederacy faced an extreme shortage of gold, silver, and copper coinage.**
- **They were forced to rely on pre-war Union coins and whatever precious little currency could be sneaked in by smugglers and blockade runners.**

As 1862 and the second year of the war dawned, both the Union and Confederate Governments found themselves in a financial crunch, albeit for very different reasons. The Confederate Government, having coined all of the silver and gold bullion that had been found when the three branch mints were seized, and having closed those same mints when an audit by the Confederate Treasurer found that the mints would not be self-sustaining as mandated by the Confederate Congress, now found that gold, silver, and even copper coinage was in extremely short supply. It consisted of Union coinage that had been in circulation in the south when the new government was formed; coinage that had been produced from the limited supply of silver and gold bullion found at the three branch mints at the time of their seizure, and what precious little Union coinage that could still be snuck into the Confederacy by smugglers and blockade runners.

The Confederate Currency Crisis

- To compensate for the shortage, the government and local banks printed unbacked paper Bank Notes, which quickly sparked bank failures.



To help overcome the shortage of currency, the Confederate Government resorted to the printing of Confederate Bank Notes, which were soon to become very unpopular when it was discovered by the civilian population that this paper money was not backed by hard gold and silver assets. Local banks received charters from the Confederate Government, without proper investigation by the government to determine what, if any, assets would be backing the issuance of this paper currency. Bank failures soon began, which only exacerbated by the hard currency crisis.

The Confederate Currency Crisis

- Merchants, farmers, and military suppliers soon refused to accept this near-worthless paper money as payment for goods.



This problem also had a marked effect on the Confederate military when local merchants, farmers, and what few factories and manufacturers that were in existence and producing goods, soon began refusing payment for goods with the Confederate-issued paper money as they did not want to be stuck with what was viewed as the near worthless Confederate paper money.

Union Financial Struggles

- **The Union faced its own financial crisis in 1862, exacerbated by fearful civilians hoarding hard currency like gold, silver, and pennies.**
- **This severe hoarding hampered the Union's ability to obtain funds to support the war effort against the South.**

The Union Government also had its share of financial issues by 1862. The South had been winning battles and handing the Union losses that had not been expected, which raised serious questions about the possibility of England recognizing the Confederacy and helping to bankroll its war effort against the Union. The hoarding of hard currency, primarily silver and gold, but including even copper pennies, by the civilian population was seriously hampering the Union's effort to obtain funds in support of the Union's efforts against the southern states.

The Union Tax Stamp Solution

- **The Lincoln Administration implemented a highly successful tax stamp program on ordinary legal papers and everyday products to raise funds.**
- **Stamps ranging from 1 cent to over \$3 provided steady revenue to help clear war debt without feeling overly burdensome to the public.**

At that point, Lincoln and his cabinet, with the support of Congress, came up with what was truly a novel tax plan to help fund the Union's war effort. In essence, the plan called for tax stamps to be issued for and required on, a vast array of ordinary legal papers and ordinary documents and products ranging from bank checks to entry of goods to leases, to mortgages, playing cards, telegrams, carte di vistas and everything in between, as seen in the list on the following slide. These tax stamps ranged in cost from 1 Cent up thru three dollars and higher depending on the type of document or product being taxed.

U.S. Civil War Revenue Tax Stamp Types

- Agreement
- Bank Check
- Bill of Lading
- Certificate
- Conveyance
- Entry of Goods
- Foreign Exchange
- Inland Exchange
- Insurance Policy
- Internal Revenue
- Lease
- Manifest
- Mortgage
- Original Process
- Passage Ticket
- Playing Cards
- Power of Attorney
- Proprietary
- Surety Bond
- Telegraph
- Will

Tax Stamps



The beauty of this system was that it required the appropriate tax stamp be purchased and affixed to every type of legal document and well as several types of items purchased yet it was not viewed as a burdensome tax and met with great success during the course of the Civil War and into at least two decades beyond the war's end when used to clear the last of the war debt.





Aurora, Ind., *Jan 18* 1865

Received of **O. P. COBB & CO.**

Three Hundred Thirty Seven & 62/100 Dollars,
in full for Hay *John Schurberger*



No 91 Jersey City, *Jan 27* 1868

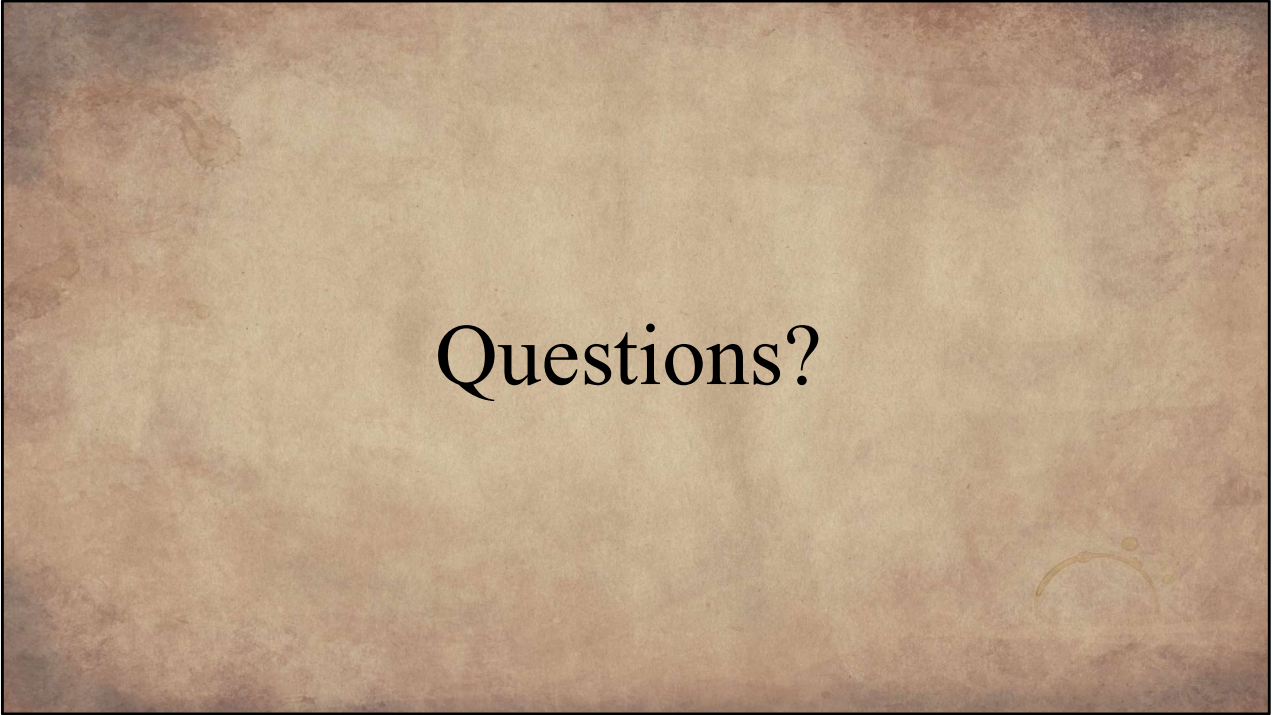
Second National Bank

Pay to the order of *Schneider & Schmidt*
Sixteen Dollars

\$16.00

Loeb, H. Dederer





Questions?

Carte de Viste's

Taxing Photography (Cartes de Visite)

- **Photography boomed during this era, popularizing inexpensive 2x3 inch "Cartes de Visite" (calling cards) featuring portraits of families and soldiers.**
- **These highly sought-after photographic novelties were subject to a 1 to 3 cent tax stamp.**

In the decade leading up to the war, photography had become well established and was inexpensive enough that a large portion the northern civilian population could afford a new product available from almost every one of the hundreds of photography studios that sprang up during the late 1850's and the early years of the war. These novelties were known as Carte di Vistas, or Calling Cards that were about 2" by 3" and contained the photograph of the paying customer(s) on one side and the photographers name and business location of the other side. (Think of them as a sort of cross between today's Business Cards and wallet size photographs). Since the glass plate negatives were kept by the photographer, reprints were usually readily available from the photographer in whatever quantity the customer wanted. The tax stamp cost ranged from 1 to 3 cents and while a Proprietary Tax stamp was usually affixed, depending on availability, other types of tax stamps were also in common usage for these Calling Cards. These cards can be found portraying children, men and women of all ages, family groups, soldiers, and government officials, although the latter two types are more rare and a lot more expensive to obtain.



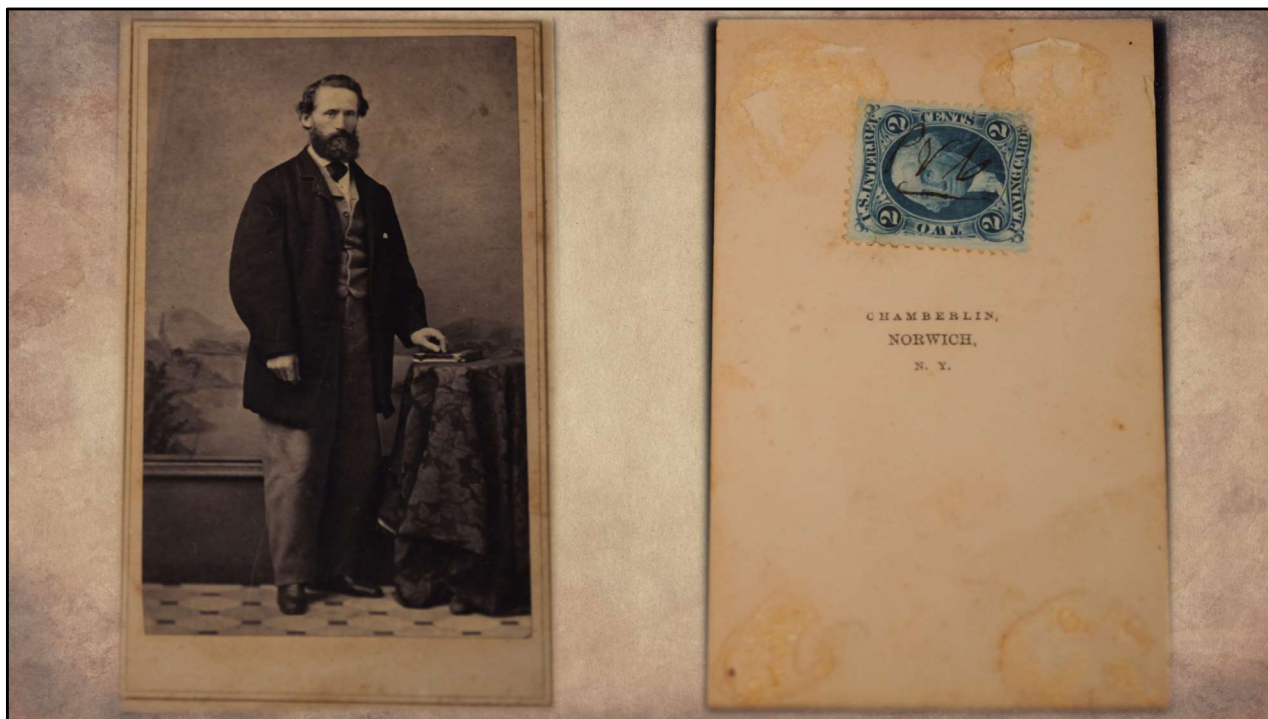


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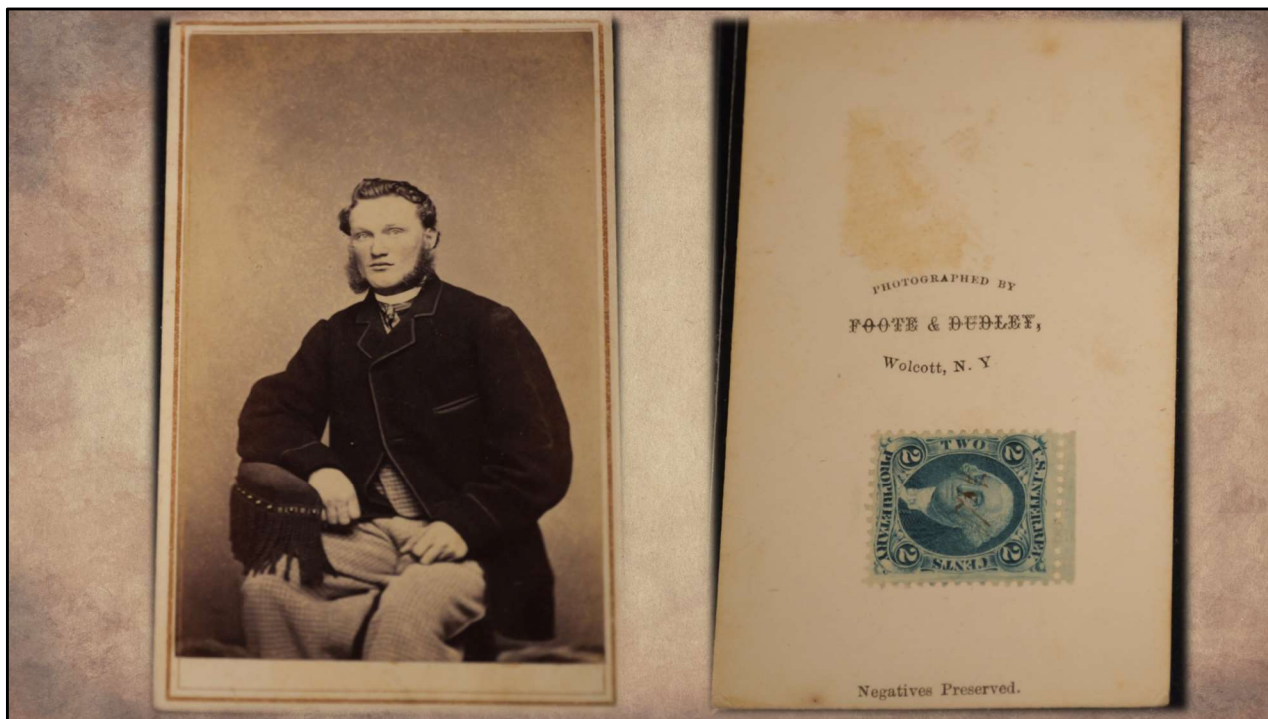
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F.B. Gage

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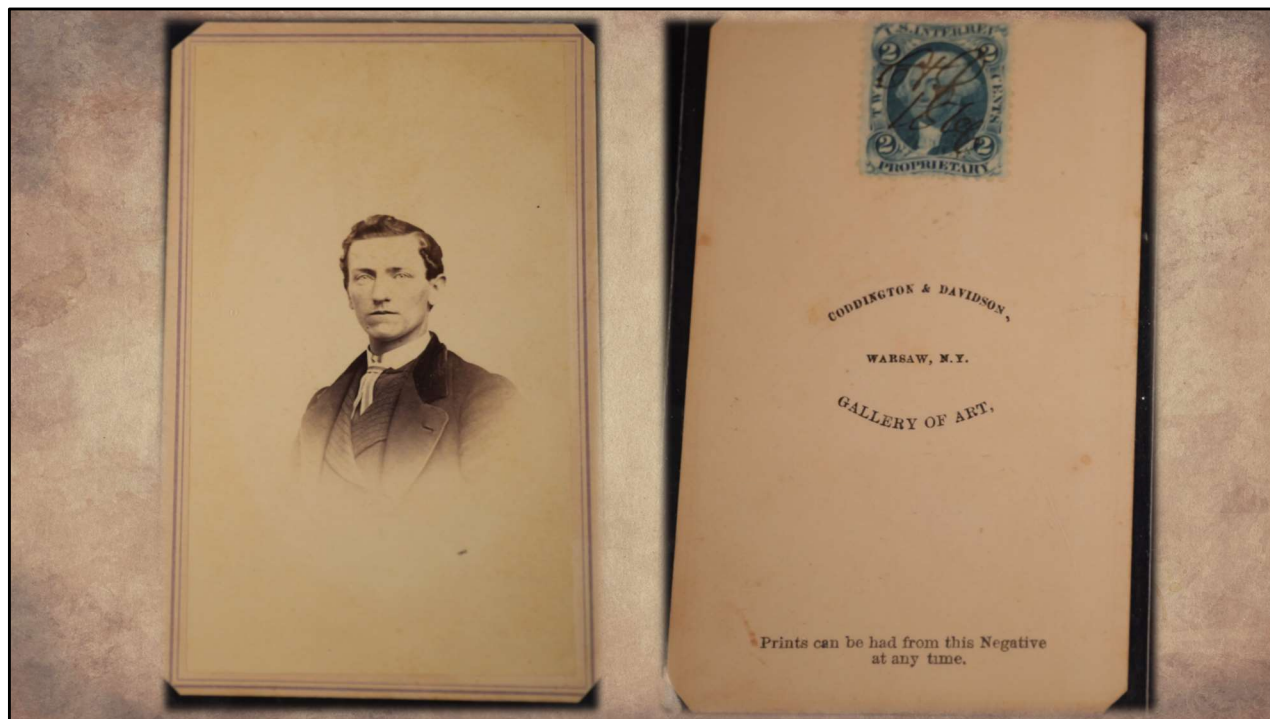






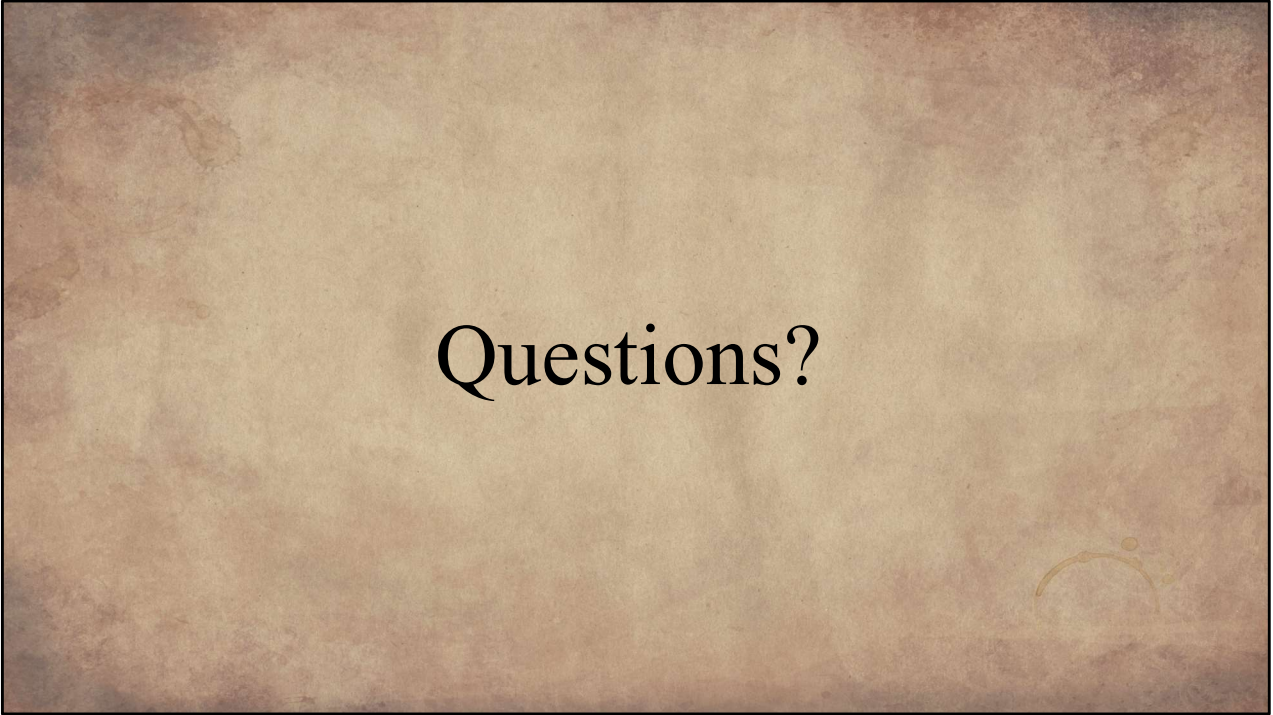












Questions?

The Postal War

The Postal War (Part 1 - Union)

- **Fearing the South would use their existing stockpile of US stamps for postage, the Union completely demonetized all current stamps.**
- **They immediately printed a new series of stamps to officially invalidate the old designs.**

As if the currency issues for both the North and the South were not enough of a head ache for the civilian populations and governments of both the north and the south, another problem was quick to arise: the postal system. The United States Post Office Department, still in its infancy having only been founded in 1847, 13 years before the start of the war, the Union soon recognized that considerable supplies of current issue United States stamps were located in all of the Confederate States, and could still be used for postage, reacted by demonetizing the total current issued stamps, making them invalid for use in both the north and the south and immediately designed and printed a totally new series of United States stamps, that while bore somewhat similar designs and colors, were still different enough from the demonetized designs to prevent usage of the older series for postage.

The Postal War (Part 2 - Confederacy)

- **The Confederacy printed their own stamps to prevent Union sympathizers from using the mail to distribute northern propaganda.**
- **Lacking engraved steel plates, early Confederate stamps were of much poorer quality than their Union counterparts.**

The Confederacy, on the other hand, had also reacted to a potential threat of the older series of stamps being used to mail Union propaganda by Union sympathizers living in the southern states and promptly designed and printed Confederate postage stamps valid for use on mail that originated in the Confederate states. Comparing the redesigned issues from both the Union and Confederate Post Office Departments, the Confederate issues are clearly of much poorer quality and design. While the US Postal Department had long been using engraved steel plates to print the nation's postage stamps, which resulted in much clearer and more attractive designs, early Confederate issues clearly showed the lack of engraved steel plate usage in the printing process, and only later into the war were able to print stamps of comparable quality to the Union issues.

Confederate Stamps



CONFEDERATE STATES POSTAGE

1861-62

Union Stamps



Head-Quarters, Army of the Potomac,



*T. P. Madden, Esq.,
San Francisco,
California*



PRIVATE FIRM US POSTAGE STAMP
1862

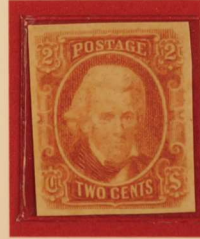


United States
Two-cent
Andrew Jackson

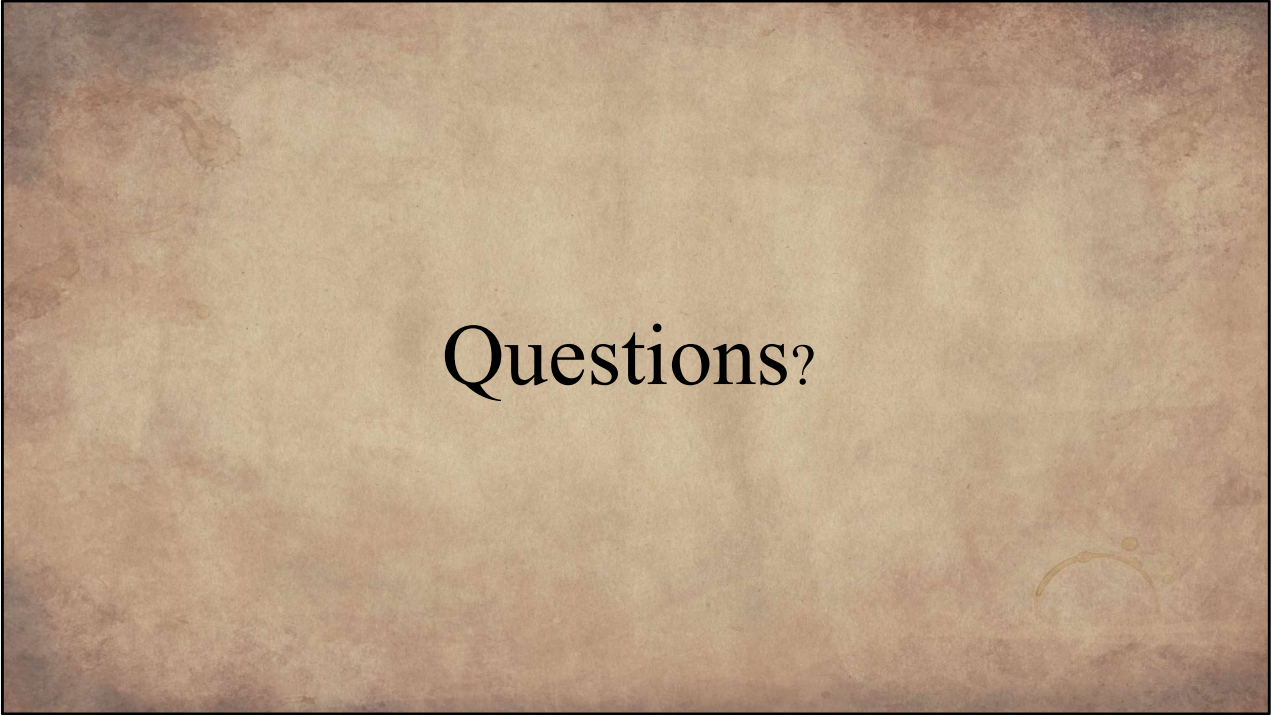


First Known Use
July 6, 1863

Confederate States
Two-cent
Andrew Jackson



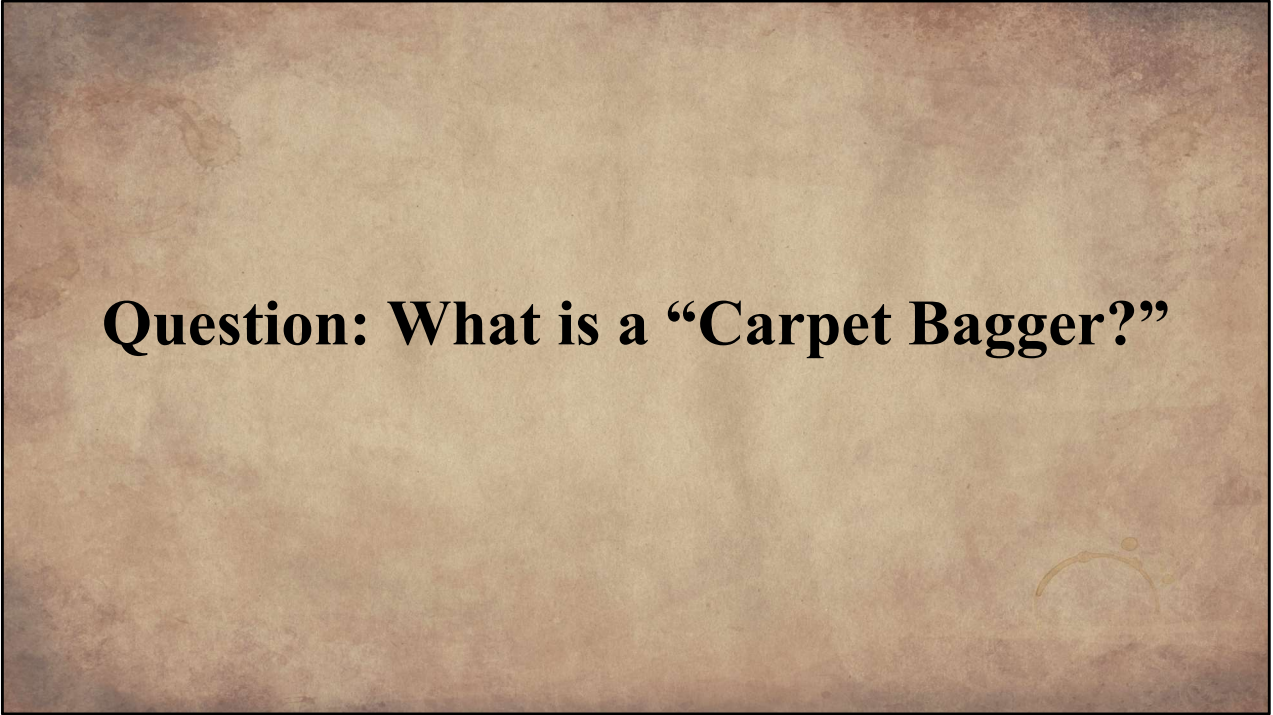
First Known Use
April 21, 1863



Questions?

The Saga of the SS Republic: The Ship with Three Lives





Question: What is a “Carpet Bagger?”

Can anyone tell me what a “Carpet Bagger” is and where the name came from??

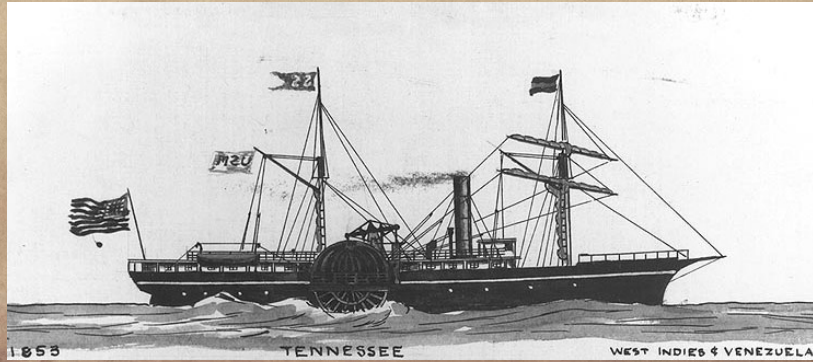
Opportunists of the South

- **Carpetbaggers were Northern citizens who packed their belongings in cheap luggage made of carpet remnants and headed South after the war.**
- **Also known as "scalawags," they sought to buy up southern land and goods for pennies on the dollar, capitalizing on the misery of survivors.**

A “Carpet Bagger” is a citizen from a Union State who, near the end of the Civil War and shortly after its end, decided to pack his belongings into literally a carpet bag (made from carpet remnants for durability and with two, usually leather, straps for ease of carrying) and head south to take advantage of the land and other goods that could be bought for usually pennies on the dollar. They were also known as scalawags because they were there to take advantage of the misery of Civil War survivors in the south. They usually travelled alone and bought what they could for either personal gain or for resale at a small profit.

The SS Tennessee (Origins)

- Built in Baltimore and christened the SS Tennessee in 1853, she was an industrial marvel of her time.
- The 210-foot ship featured massive 28-foot iron sidewheels, accommodating 100 passengers and 5,000 barrels of cargo.



Let us now pick up the story of the SS Republic. Built in Baltimore, she was christened the SS Tennessee in 1853. She was an industrial marvel, 210 feet in length and 34 feet wide with a massive single piston driving two 28- foot iron sidewheels. This stout ship could transport 100 passengers and fit 5,000 barrels of cargo in her hold.

The SS Tennessee (Early Years)

- **Before the Civil War, the ship had several marginally profitable stints as a passenger and cargo vessel.**
- **Her early routes included trips to France, transporting miners to the California gold fields, and carrying soldiers to Nicaragua.**

She had a few short and marginally profitable stints as a passenger/cargo ship with trips to France, as transport for minors headed to the gold fields in California and as transport for soldiers of fortune to fight in Nicaragua for the infamous William Walker.

A Ship of War

- **Impounded by the Confederacy as a blockade runner, she was eventually captured by Union forces at New Orleans.**
- **Refitted as a well-armed Union warship, she served as Admiral David Farragut's flagship in several battles, including Mobile Bay.**

At the onset of the Civil War, the Tennessee was impounded by the Confederate Navy as a blockade runner. Union ships were dispatched to hunt her down, but it wasn't until the capture of New Orleans that she fell into Union hands. The Tennessee was turned into a well-armed fighting ship for the Union Navy and often served as Admiral David Farragut's flagship in several naval battles, including the Battle of Mobile Bay made famous by Farragut's exclamation "Damn the Torpedoes – Full Speed Ahead".

Rebirth as the SS Republic

- **After gale damage ended her military service, a New York shipping magnate purchased the crippled hull in 1865 and renamed her the SS Republic.**
- **Following an extensive refit, she began regular runs to New Orleans, carrying cargo and currency to fuel the city's expanding post-war economy.**
- **She steamed out of New York on October 18, 1865, on what would be her final voyage—Mother Nature's intervention would soon ruin the plans of Northern investors aboard, who were hoping to use this voyage to profit heavily off the war-wrecked Southern economy.**

Her military career ended abruptly when her hull was damaged in a gale, and in 1865 a New York shipping magnate bought the crippled ship and renamed her SS Republic. After an extensive refit, she was soon making regular runs from New York to New Orleans with shipments of cargo and money to fuel the city's expanding post-war economy. She steamed out of New York on October 18th, 1865 bound for New Orleans on what would be her final voyage, for it was at this point mother nature intervened in what would become an upset of plans laid by a group of northern investors to make a profit on the misery of the southern war - wrecked economy.

A Cargo of Relief and Profit

- **The ship's manifest included vital philanthropic aid: school supplies, bottled medicines, wines, and preserves to feed the hungry in New Orleans parishes.**
- **Northern church groups also sent religious supplies to help rebuild and furnish southern churches devastated by the war.**



Her cargo for this voyage included school supplies for what was left of the southern school system in New Orleans; religious supplies sent by northern church groups to rebuild and furnish churches in the greater New Orleans area that had been damaged or destroyed during the war; bottled medicines, wines, and even bottled preserves to help feed the hungry in the New Orleans parishes.

The Investors' Treasure

- **Hidden among the relief supplies was a massive shipment of gold and silver specie totaling over \$400,000.**
- **This treasure belonged to Northern investors—carpetbaggers on a grand scale—planning to purchase choice Southern land.**

But of far greater importance to a select group of Northern investors (carpet baggers on a grand scale) was a massive shipment of gold and silver specie totaling slightly over \$400,000 to be used to purchase choice parcels of land in the war- ravaged south. And this is where Mother Nature stepped in and ruined the best laid plans of those trying to help rebuild the south as well as those who were seeking to turn a profit on their acquisition of southern land for pennies on the dollar.

Caught in the Hurricane

- Five days after leaving New York, the Republic was caught and stalled without power in a fierce hurricane.
- Despite passengers laboring for hours to bail the hold, the ship began to succumb to the sea.

As mentioned earlier, the SS Republic steamed out of New York on October 18th, 1865 on what was to be her final voyage. On the fifth day, a gale blew in and by nightfall, the Republic was stalled without power in a fierce hurricane. Passengers labored for hours to bail out the ship's hold, but it was a futile effort.

The Sinking of the Republic

- The crew worked feverishly in the final moments to prepare lifeboats and makeshift rafts for the survivors.
- At 4:00 PM on October 25th, the SS Republic sank 1,700 feet to the ocean floor, taking her \$400,000 treasure with her.

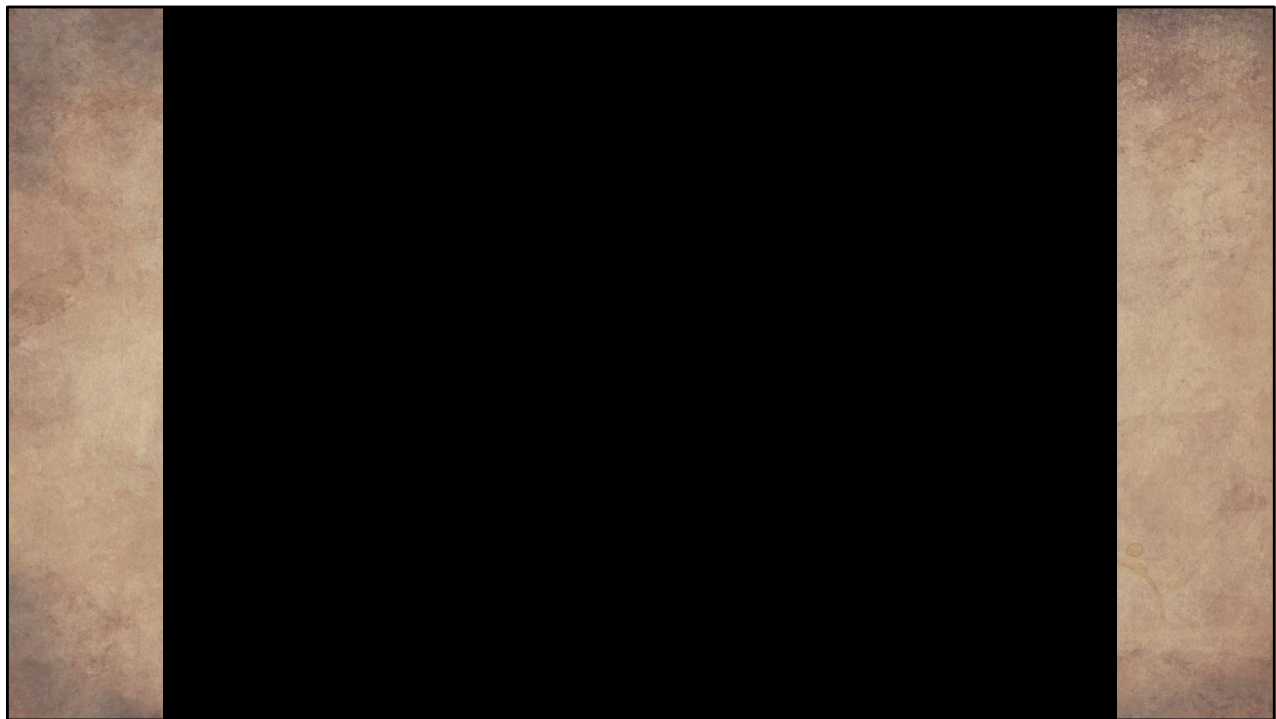


Her crew worked feverishly to prepare the lifeboats and patch together a makeshift raft. At 4:00 PM on October 25th the SS Republic sank into the sea, settling to the ocean floor at a depth of 1700 feet. Published accounts of the survivor's harrowing tales were accompanied by newspaper reports that "some \$400,000 in treasure had gone down with the ship."

Rediscovery & Recovery

- **We will now look at survivor accounts and the eventual partial recovery of the ship's cargo by Odyssey Marine Exploration.**

We now pickup the survivor's accounts and the efforts to recover the ship's cargo and the \$400,000 in gold and silver specie courtesy of scenes from a DVD by Odyssey Marine Exploration, who was eventually successful in a partial recovery of the Republic's cargo.



The SS Republic

- **The fateful end of the SS Republic unexpectedly impacted both the North and the South.**
- **Mother Nature intervened at a time when her cargo represented both salvation for the desperate and exploitation by opportunists.**

So ends the story of the gallant SS Republic, and its fateful end that impacted both the North and the South in a way that neither saw coming, at a time when her cargo could have meant either salvation, or damnation for both sides of the greatest war this restored nation has ever witnessed.

“Treasure” of the SS Republic



As a Civil War enthusiast, and an amateur numismatist with a fascination for US coinage of the Civil War era, I have been very fortunate in obtaining two examples of Civil War coinage that went down with the SS Republic, were recovered after 140 years at the bottom of the Atlantic Ocean and conserved to the state that you now see them in today.

“Treasure” of the SS Republic



“Treasure” of the SS Republic



“Treasure” of the SS Republic





Thank you for attending!

This concludes my presentation on the Civilian impact, funding of the war, and the SS Republic! Thank you for attending today!

There is also a survey that you can fill out to leave comments on this presentation, or even submit suggestions on what topics to cover in the future!